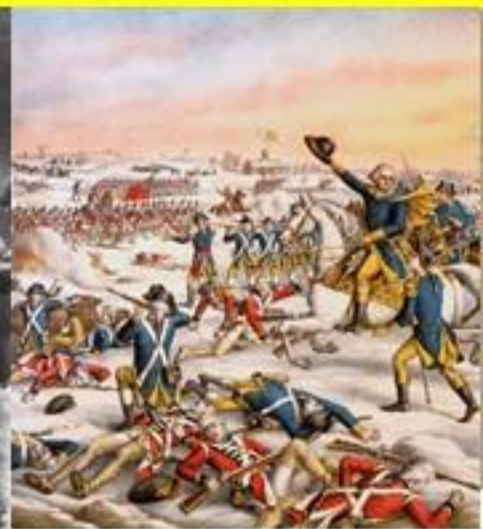


WORLD HISTORY



MODULE - 13

FRENCH REVOLUTION - 2

FALL OF THE BASTILLE

- 1** Although the king recognized the National Assembly, he decided to suppress it.
- 2** A large number of soldiers were brought to Versailles and Paris.
- 3** Necker, the popular minister was also dismissed.
- 4** On hearing this, the mob of Paris became violent.
- 5** They attacked the State prison called the Bastille, murdered the guards and freed the prisoners.
- 6** The fall of the Bastille was regarded in France as a triumph of liberty.
- 7** After the fall of the Bastille the peasants rose against the nobles.



FALL OF THE BASTILLE

- 8 Riots began against the aristocrats all over France.
- 9 Nobles were attacked and their castles stormed.
- 10 They also destroyed the records of their feudal services.
- 11 The nobles voluntarily surrendered their feudal rights and the privileges on 4th August 1789. Feudalism and serfdom were abolished.



FALL OF THE BASTILLE

- 12** The principle of equality was established. Class distinctions were abolished.
- 13** There was a shortage for bread in Paris. On 5th October, a large number of women went to the King's palace at Versailles to make a petition.
- 14** They were not satisfied with the reply of the queen and hence they brought with them the king, the queen and their son to Paris.



WORK OF THE NATIONAL ASSEMBLY (1789 - 1791)

- 1** The National Assembly styled itself the Constituent Assembly.
- 2** It drew up the Declaration of the Rights of Man.
- 3** The new constitution drafted by the Constituent Assembly provided for a limited monarchy to France.
- 4** The titles of the nobles were abolished.





JUDICIARY

- It was remodeled.
- The method of torture was abolished.
- New central and local courts were established.
- Judges were to be elected.

ACTION AGAINST CHURCH

- Drastic action was also taken against the church.
- The monasteries were suppressed.
- Absolute religious toleration was proclaimed.
- The collection of tithes by the church was abolished.
- Then, measures were taken for the nationalization of church properties.

After drafting the new constitution, the National Assembly dissolved itself in 1791.



POLITICAL CLUBS

- 1 The political clubs sprang up in different quarters.
- 2 Of these, the most conspicuous were the Jacobian Club and Cordelier Club.
- 3 The Jacobian Club was led by Robespierre, a radical democrat.
- 4 The Cordelier Club was led by Danton.
- 5 The Girondists were a group of eloquent young men and stood for establishing a republican form of government. Madame Roland was a prominent member of the Girondists.



THE LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY

- 1** According to the new constitution, the new Legislative Assembly met in 1791.
- 2** When the revolution broke out many of the nobles managed to escape from France.
- 3** They carried out propaganda against the revolution in France and tried to mobilize support from other countries.
- 4** Austria and Prussia came forward to help them.
- 5** To curtail their activities the Legislative Assembly passed laws.
- 6** The king did not approve of these laws and used his veto against them.

- 7** King Leopold of Austria issued the famous Declaration of Pillnitz against the revolutionaries on 27th August 1791.



8 War broke out between the revolutionary government and Austria in 1792. The revolutionary army was defeated.

9 The wrath of the revolutionaries turned against the French king.

10 On 10th August 1792 the mob attacked the King's palace at Tuileries.

11 The king was suspended and elections were ordered for a National Convention to prepare another new constitution for the country. This was followed by the "September Massacres".

12 The Revolutionary government at Paris led by Danton massacred 1500 suspected supporters of the French king.

13 Then the French army defeated the Austrian army at Valmy.



THE NATIONAL CONVENTION (1792 - 1795)

- 1** After the dissolution of the Legislative Assembly, the National Convention met in 1792.
- 2** It abolished monarchy and declared France as a republic.
- 3** The king Louis XVI after a summary trial was found guilty of treason was guillotined on Sunday, 21st January 1793.
- 4** Three days later the queen Marie Antoinette was also guillotined.



REIGN OF TERROR

1 The National convention divided on the issue of the execution of the king.

2 The moderates did not agree with the Jacobians, who formed the majority in the Convention.

3 The Jacobians had set up the Revolutionary Tribunal to deal with the moderates.

4 It was the beginning of the Reign of Terror.

5 It was the final phase of the Revolution.

6 It was also the darkest period of the Revolution.

7 Riots broke out in many places like Lyons, Marseilles and other cities.



REIGN OF TERROR

8 In 1793, the first coalition was formed by the European nations against the revolutionary government.

9 The Jacobians suspended the constitution and created the Committee of Public Safety with full powers to deal with the situation.

10 Robespierre was the leader of this committee.

11 It put down all the riots staged by the royalists within the country.

12 Many people were killed on suspicion of being royalists.

13 Soon, Robespierre became a virtual dictator of France.

14 But, his opponents turned against him and sent him to the guillotine in 1794.



**Maximilien de
Robespierre**

- 1 With the fall of Robespierre the Reign of Terror gradually came to an end.
- 2 Moreover the public opinion was strongly against it.
- 3 The Revolutionary Tribunal was suspended.
- 4 The functions of Committee of Public Safety were restricted.
- 5 The Jacobian Club was closed.
- 6 The National Convention at last took up its long neglected task of framing of a constitution for the French Republic.



- 7** The executive was entrusted to a Directory, consisting of five members.
- 8** The legislative power was entrusted to two houses called the Council of Five Hundred and the Council of the Ancients.
- 9** Napoleon Bonaparte was then at Paris and he was entrusted with the task of defending the Convention against the Parisian mob.
- 10** He dispersed the mob and saved the Convention and began his brilliant career.

- 11** On October 26, 1795 the convention declared itself dissolved and the Directory took charge of the French government.



Napoleon Bonaparte

RESULTS OF THE REVOLUTION

- 1** The French Revolution of 1789 inaugurated a new era in the history of the mankind.
- 2** The ideas of “liberty, equality and fraternity” spread to other parts of the world.
- 3** The Bourbon monarchy was abolished.
- 4** The malpractices of Church and higher Clergy were checked by the Revolution.
- 5** The revolution abolished the feudal system and brought upon a new way of living, capitalism, which is still practiced today throughout Europe.
- 6** The Revolution rejected tyranny, divine right, conservatism, and feudal vestiges associated with bourbon rule in France.
- 7** At the same time it failed to establish a permanent Republic in France.
- 8** The French Revolution, after a violent turn led to the emergence of a great dictator, Napoleon Bonaparte.



SEQUENCE OF EVENTS

French Revolution	New chapter-history of Europe-turning point-history of humankind.
It acted against	Age old absolute monarchy, feudal laws and social inequality.
Idea of republicanism	Liberty, Equality and Fraternity
Ideas influenced	Europe and the world
Louis XVI	most incompetent ruler-Queen interference in administration-bias-French nobles
Social Inequality	Three major divisions-the nobles, clergy and the common people.
Economic Decline	Louis XVI-national debt had increased
Turgot, Jacques Necker and Calonne	Appointed financial experts-to look into the financial crisis.
States General	Main Purpose-consent for the fresh taxes- three Estates Chambers.
National Assembly	Third estate demanded a joint sitting and one vote for each member-rejected- declared itself as the National Assembly.
Tennis Court Oath	Members of the National Assembly went to a nearby Tennis Court - oath - a new constitution.
French philosophers	Montesquieu, Voltaire and Rousseau.
American Revolution	Fighting spirit for the cause of democracy

SEQUENCE OF EVENTS

Fall of the Bastille	They attacked the State prison called the Bastille, murdered the guards and freed the prisoners- triumph of liberty.
Constituent Assembly	National Assembly styled itself the Constituent Assembly- limited monarchy- titles of the nobles abolished- Judiciary remodeled- action against the church.
Political clubs	Jacobian Club ,Cordelier Club and Girondists.
Legislative Assembly	Formed according to new constitution.
National Convention	After the dissolution of the Legislative Assembly- abolished monarchy and declared France as a republic.
Guillotined	King Louis XVI and Queen Maire Antoinette- guilty of treason
Reign of Terror	The Jacobians -Revolutionary Tribunal to deal with the moderates- final phase- darkest period- Jacobians suspended the constitution- Committee of Public Safety- Robespierre
End of Revolution	National Convention- framing of a constitution-role Napoleon Bonaparte- convention got dissolved- French government formed
Result of Revolution	Permanent Republic in France- role Napoleon Bonaparte

QUESTIONS FOR PRACTICE

1. How did the French Revolution differ from the American Revolution?

150 words

2. How were Enlightenment ideals reflected in the French Revolution?

150 words

3. What was the cause of Reign of Terror during the French Revolution?

150 words

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